

If a road safety barrier is to be used, its design must be based on the speed of traffic past the barrier. In most cases, this will be a semi-permanent reduced speed limit posted at the site which generally applies 24 hours a day / 7 days a week, with other further temporary reductions only applicable when required for works which are occurring. Where a general reduction in speed limit past the site has not been implemented, the permanent posted speed limit must be used as the design speed for the road safety barrier design.

The requirements of Section 2.5.9 are applicable to the design speed. If the traffic speed is greater than 10 km/h higher or lower than the speed limit past the road safety barrier, the speed of traffic must be used as the design speed for the road safety barrier design.

Speed limits past the road safety barrier must be monitored throughout the completion of works to ensure compliance with the road safety barrier design speed.

Safety barriers are typically used to:

- separate road users from severe hazard (e.g. deep excavation, a bridge pier, stockpile)
- separate traffic travelling in opposite directions
- reduce delays by avoiding more restrictive speed limits
- protect road workers and vulnerable road users (e.g. road shoulder as a temporary footpath) from narrow lateral clearance to moving traffic (e.g. when the work area is closer than 3 m to the nearest edge of traffic and the speed limit is more than 60 km/h). For work areas located more than 6 m to the nearest edge of traffic see Section 3: Around the Worksite.

End treatments must be provided when installing road safety barrier systems, ensuring they are immediately operational as part of the barrier system. They are designed to absorb energy and reduce the severity of impacts, also assisting in reducing the risk of errant vehicles entering the work area and road users accidentally impacting the barrier. End treatment options include:

- starting or connecting the barrier to the end of a permanent barrier or guardrail
- securely attaching any approved end treatment as per the Austroads Guide to Road Design Part 6 (e.g. crash cushions).